INCH-POUND

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DETAIL SPECIFICATION

DETONATING CORD ASSEMBLY (DCA)

This specification is approved for use by the Naval Surface Warfare Center Indian Head Division (NSWCIHD) and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Departments of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of detonating cord assemblies (DCA) (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. DCAs are of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.1 Types.

a. Type I – Standard thin layer explosive (TLX) line. This line has a high explosive fitting on each end.

b. Type II – Referred to as "High flexure TLX line." This is the same as a standard TLX line, except the outer surface of the assembly, between the end fittings, is covered with a protective layer of material to prevent chaffing during flexure.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTIONS

A-A-59281 - Cleaning Compound, Solvent Mixtures

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-PRF-46010 - Lubricant, Solid Film, Heat Cured, Corrosion Inhibiting

MIL-C-83125 - Cartridges for Cartridge Actuated/Propellant Actuated Devices

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, ATTN: SEA 05S, 1333 Isaac Hull Avenue, SE, Stop 5160, Washington Navy Yard, DC 20376-5160 or emailed to CommandStandards@navy.mil, with the subject line "Document Comment". Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 1377

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-810 - Environmental Engineering Considerations and Laboratory Tests

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

NSWC IHD SPECIFICATIONS (CAGE CODE 14083)

WS 5003 - HNS Explosive

(Copies of this document are available from Commander, Indian Head Division, Naval Surface Warfare Center, CAD/PAD Data Management Branch (Code E26), 4393 Benson Road, BLDG 1557, Indian Head, MD 20640-5092. Refer questions, inquires, or problems to nswc_iheodtd_dmo@navy.mil.)

NAVAL AIR SYSTEMS COMMAND (NAVAIR) DRAWINGS

841AS801 - Fitting Sensitivity Test

841AS802 - Connector, Tee

841AS803 - Dent Block

841AS804 - Holder, SMDC Dent Block

850AS875 - Cord Assembly, Detonating RAU-2/A

(Copies of these documents are available online via Joint Engineering Data Management Information and Control System [JEDMICS] at https://jedmics.navair.navy.mil/webjedmics/index.jsp. Refer questions, inquiries, or problems to nani_customerservice@navy.mil.)

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM B117 - Standard Practice for Operating Salt Spray (Fog) Apparatus

ASTM D1141 - Standard Practices for the Preparation of Substitute Ocean Water

ASTM E748 - Standard Practices for Thermal Neutron Radiography of Materials

ASTM E1742/E1742M - Standard Practices for Radiographic Examination

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org.)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2 and 6.3), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.2.

3.2 Design and construction. The DCA and all its components shall be manufactured in accordance with Drawing 850AS875. Each individual DCA shall conform to the configuration of the appropriate part number and satisfy any additional tests or inspections specified therein.

3.3 Materials. All materials used in the manufacture of the DCA shall conform to the standards established at technical service release as specified (see 6.2). Any divergence shall require technical evaluation and potential design certification testing.

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3.4 Primary components. For the purpose of this specification, the thin layer explosive (high melting explosive [HMX] and aluminum), the booster tip explosive (HNS, WS 5003), TLX loaded cord, and transfer charge are considered primary components. Only primary components from a single lot shall be used in a production lot of DCAs; however, one primary component production lot may be used in more than one DCA production lot.

3.5 DCA requirements.

3.5.1 Length stabilization. The cord shall be annealed to stabilize cord length prior to use. The minimum percent shrinkage achieved when first annealed shall be not less than 1.25 percent of the cord total length. When retested in accordance with 4.5.1, the maximum shrinkage shall be 0.2 percent of the sample length.

3.5.2 Detonation velocity. The cord detonation velocity shall be 4,593 to 8,202 feet per second (1,400 to 2,500 meters per second) when tested in accordance with 4.5.2.

3.5.3 Explosive weight. The explosive weight of the cord shall be 20±10 milligrams of HMX and aluminum per meter when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.

3.5.4 Visual requirements. DCAs shall be free of visual defects such as burrs, deep scratches, defective ferrules and fittings, corrosion, chipped surfaces, or other defects which may prevent assembly or affect the environmental stability of the line when examined in accordance with 4.5.4. The part number tape, identification tape, clamp point tape, and identification plate shall be in accordance with Drawing 850AS875.

3.5.5 Radiographic requirement.

3.5.5.1 X-ray. X-ray shall be conducted in accordance with 4.5.5.1. When examined in accordance with 4.5.5, there shall be no observable imperfections in components or assembly of the DCA lines.

3.5.5.2 N-ray. N-ray shall be conducted in accordance with 4.5.5.2. When examined in accordance with 4.5.5, there shall be no observable imperfections in components or assembly of the DCA lines.

3.5.6 Corrosion. All components scheduled for use in production shall be free of corrosive products (see 4.5.6). The threads of the DCA end fittings shall be dry film lubricated with a black or natural color lubricant that meets the requirements of MIL-PRF-46010.

3.5.7 End fittings leakage. End fittings shall exhibit a leak rate of not greater than 10^{-5} cubic centimeter per second (cc/sec) of air at a pressure differential of 1±0.1 atmosphere when tested in accordance with 4.5.7.

3.5.8 End fitting tensile strength. The end fitting joint between the outer ferrule and the braided stainless steel casing shall be capable of withstanding a tensile load of 150 pounds minimum when tested in accordance with 4.5.8.

3.6 Environmental conditions.

3.6.1 Temperature-shock/humidity/shock/altitude. The DCA shall not initiate or incur any degradation or damage when exposed to temperature-shock/humidity/altitude environments in accordance with MIL-C-83125 and 4.5.9. After subjection to temperature-shock/humidity/altitude, the DCA shall meet the performance requirements of 3.7.

3.6.2 Shock. The DCA shall not initiate or incur any degradation or damage when exposed to shock when tested in accordance with 4.5.10.

3.6.3 Vibration (sinusoidal). The DCA shall not initiate or incur any degradation or damage when exposed to sinusoidal vibration when tested in accordance with 4.5.11.

3.6.4 Pressure cycling. The DCA shall withstand pressure cycling from 3 inches of mercury to 29.92 inches of mercury at temperatures of -65 to 350 °F when tested in accordance with 4.5.12.

3.6.5 Temperature cycling. The DCA shall withstand temperature cycling between temperatures of -65 to 350 °F when tested in accordance with 4.5.13.

3.6.6 Minimum bend/flex. The DCA shall withstand a minimum of four turns on a 1-inch diameter helix along the centerline for 4 hours minimum when tested in accordance with 4.5.14.

3.6.7 Flexure (type II only). When tested in accordance with 4.5.15, type II lines shall be capable of 3,000 cycles of flexure with no degradation or damage when installed between the F-18 fuselage and the canopy.

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3.6.8 Salt fog. The DCA shall withstand exposure to salt fog when tested in accordance with 4.5.16.

3.6.9 Solvent resistance. The DCA shall withstand repeated exposure to general purpose cleaner (A-A-59281, type I) when tested in accordance with 4.5.17.

3.7 Ballistic requirements. The DCA, when conditioned in accordance with 4.5.18, shall propagate the full length and produce an indent of at least 0.040 inch in a 6061-T6 aluminum dent block (Drawing 841AS803) secured in a dent block holder (Drawing 841AS804).

3.7.1 End fitting torque. Aluminum end fittings shall withstand 90 inch-pounds minimum assembly torque without deformation, while stainless steel end fittings shall withstand 120 inch-pounds.

3.7.2 Energy stimulus. DCAs shall be configured such that the energy stimulus is contained and shall not emit shrapnel when fired in the “as-installed” condition in accordance with 4.5.18.

3.7.3 Intact. DCA end fittings shall remain intact in the port. Out-gassing of the DCA and fraying of the stainless steel overbraid are permissible, provided that some of the overbraid remains intact and the aforementioned criteria is met. DCAs shall be constructed such that the portion of the assembly between end fittings shall not separate or disengage from the end fittings when fired in the installed condition at the temperatures specified herein in accordance with 4.5.18.

3.8 Workmanship. DCAs shall be constructed and finished in a manner to assure compliance with all requirements of this specification. Particular attention shall be directed to dimensions, finishes, crimping, sealing, and assembly operations.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.2).

b. Production inspection (see 4.3).

c. Lot acceptance inspection (see 4.4).

4.2 First article inspection. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2 and 6.3), a first article sample of 23 DCA lines shall be subjected to first article testing. Twenty-two of these DCA lines shall be expended in the tests listed in table I, while one DCA shall be retained for investigative purposes. Environmental exposure shall be conducted sequentially as listed in table I. First article inspection shall be performed on sample units that have been produced with equipment and procedures normally used in production. First article testing is for the purpose of determining that the contractor, prior to starting production, is capable of producing items that comply with the technical requirements as specified in the contract. A first article inspection shall be required if two or more years have passed since the item was manufactured, after major turnover in personnel, following major changes to the production facility, or following transfer of production to a new facility or site. Failure of any DCA to comply with the requirements of table I shall be cause for rejection of the first article represented.

TABLE I. First article inspection.

Test	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Quantity					
X-ray	3.5.5.1	4.5.5.1	5	5	3	3	3	3
N-ray	3.5.5.2	4.5.5.2	5	5	3	3	3	3
Visual	3.5.4	4.5.4	5	5	3	3	3	3
Temp-shock/humidity/shock/altitude	3.6.1	4.5.9	5	5	--	--	--	--
20 G shock	3.6.2	4.5.10	5	5	--	--	--	--
Vibration (sinusoidal)	3.6.3	4.5.11	5	5	--	--	--	--
Pressure cycling	3.6.4	4.5.12	5	5	--	--	--	--
Temperature cycling	3.6.5	4.5.13	5	5	--	--	--	--

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TABLE I. First article inspection – Continued.

Test	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	Quantity					
Minimum bend/flex	3.6.6	4.5.14	--	--	3	3	--	--
Flexure (type II only)	3.6.7	4.5.15	5	5	--	--	--	--
Salt fog	3.6.8	4.5.16	5	5	--	--	--	--
Solvent resistance	3.6.9	4.5.17	--	--	--	--	3	3
Ballistics (-65 °F)	3.7	4.5.18	5	--	3	--	3	--
Ballistics (200 °F)	3.7	4.5.18	--	5	--	3	--	3

4.3 Production inspection. All DCA shall be inspected and screened to the examinations and tests listed in table II.

TABLE II. Production inspection.

Requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph
Length stabilization	3.5.1	4.5.1
Detonation velocity	3.5.2	4.5.2
Explosive weight	3.5.3	4.5.3
Visual inspection	3.5.4	4.5.4
X-ray	3.5.5.1	4.5.5.1
N-ray	3.5.5.2	4.5.5.2
Corrosion	3.5.6	4.5.6
End fittings leakage	3.5.7	4.5.7

4.4 Lot acceptance inspection. Lot acceptance shall consist of the examinations and tests specified in table III. Failure of any sample to comply with the requirements of table III shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

TABLE III Lot acceptance inspection.

Test	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph
Visual	3.5.4	4.5.4
X-ray	3.5.5.1	4.5.5.1
N-ray	3.5.5.2	4.5.5.2
End fitting tensile strength	3.5.8	4.5.8
Ballistics	3.7	4.5.18

4.4.1 Lot size. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the DCA production lot size shall be from 91 minimum to 500 maximum. DCAs required for all test purposes shall be randomly selected from the production lot and shall not be applied as a part of the quantity specified for delivery (see 6.2).

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4.4.2 Sampling. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), ballistic samples shall be randomly selected per table IV, with two samples retained regardless of lot size.

TABLE IV. Sample selection.

Lot size range	Sample size	Ballistic test quantity	End fitting tensile test quantity
91 to 150	25	20	5
151 to 280	35	30	5
281 to 500	55	50	5

4.5 Inspections and tests.

4.5.1 Length stabilization. The TLX cord, prior to its use in TLX manufacture, shall be annealed at a stabilized temperature of 300±5 °F for 60 to 65 minutes continuously. For every continuous length of cord annealed (approximately 1,000 feet max.), 3 samples (36±0.10 inches per sample) shall be cut from the cord. These samples shall be annealed to the time and temperature described above and shall meet the requirement of 3.5.1 for retest.

4.5.2 Detonation velocity. Each end and every 500 feet of planned cord production shall be tested for velocity measurement prior to producing any DCAs.

4.5.3 Explosive weight. Every 1,000 feet, a 1-meter section of cord shall be taken and the explosive shall be removed from the cord. The residue shall be weighed to the nearest milligram to verify explosive weight in accordance with 3.5.3.

4.5.4 Visual inspection. The external condition and appearance of the DCAs shall be determined by comparison to Drawing 850AS875. Specific inspections of the steel overbraid, identification label, end fitting assemblies, ferrules, booster cups, collars, seals, and fitting nuts shall be conducted at a minimum. Each DCA shall meet the requirements of 3.5.4.

4.5.5 Radiographic examination. All DCAs in the first article sample or production lot shall be radiographically examined in accordance with ASTM E1742/E1742M and ASTM E748. Any observable imperfections in components or assembly of the DCA lines shall be cause for rejection. The DCAs shall be positioned on their sides for the most revealing exposure. All DCAs shall be identified with serial numbers prior to examination. The serial numbers shall be in consecutive numerical order. DCAs shall be arranged on trays or boards in consecutive numerical order, and each radiograph shall carry a permanent identification displayed thereon. The radiographic identification shall include the complete lot number, the contract number, drawing number, the respective A/B end labeling, and the span of serial numbers displayed. Defective assemblies found by the vendor shall be clearly identified on the X-ray or N-ray and removed from the production lot. The serial numbers shall be located apart from other markings.

4.5.5.1 X-ray. X-ray shall show each DCA end assembly and approximately 3 inches of line behind the tips.

4.5.5.2 N-ray. N-ray shall show each DCA end fitting assembly and approximately 3 inches of the adjacent line along the length of the longitudinal axis.

4.5.6 Examination for corrosion. All parts shall be visually inspected to ensure there are no products that may cause corrosion on the hardware and that the threads are coated with dry film lubricant.

4.5.7 End fitting leakage. Each end fitting shall be tested in a dry gas leakage tester to demonstrate that the requirement of 3.5.7 is met. End fittings that exhibit a leak rate in excess of that specified in 3.5.7 shall be rejected.

4.5.8 End fitting tensile strength. Five DCAs from the lot acceptance test sample shall be subjected to the 150-pound load test to verify the fitting strength. The 150-pound load shall be reached by applying the load at a rate of 6 pounds per second. The load shall be maintained for 60 seconds minimum. The lines shall be radiographed and any units showing a gap greater than 0.050 inch between the bottom center bore and the Halar shall constitute cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.5.9 Temperature-shock/humidity/altitude. Ten assemblies shall be subjected to the 28-day exposure to temperature-shock/humidity/altitude environments in accordance with MIL-C-83125.

4.5.10 20 G shock. The 20 G shock test shall be conducted on 10 assemblies to ensure that the requirements of MIL-STD-810, method 516, procedure I is met. The shock pulse waveform shall be terminal peak sawtooth. The amplitude shall be 20 G and the duration 11 milliseconds. Tips and centers of the lines shall be supported as in actual installation.

4.5.11 Vibration (sinusoidal). This test shall be conducted on 10 assemblies in accordance with the vibration test selection chart of MIL-STD-810 (Aircraft category, procedure 1, parts 1, 2, and 3, and curve Z up to and including 2,000 cps), except that for each resonant and cycling period the test specimen shall be divided equally for vibration at -65, 70, and 200 °F.

4.5.12 Pressure cycling. Ten assemblies shall be subjected to a minimum of 100 pressure cycles with 50 cycles conducted at 350 °F and 50 cycles at -65 °F. One pressure cycle shall consist of the following sequence: the pressure shall be 29.92 inches mercury (Hg) and held for 5 minutes and then reduced to 3 inches Hg in not greater than 5 minutes. The absolute pressures shall be maintained at 3 inches Hg for 25 minutes, then increased to 29.92 inches Hg in not greater than 5 minutes and maintained at 29.92 inches Hg for 25 minutes. There shall be no withdrawals during the pressure cycling. Prior to the continuation of the environmental exposures listed in table I, the requirements of 3.5.7 shall be met after exposure to pressure cycling.

4.5.13 Temperature cycling. After pressure cycling, the 10 DCAs shall be subjected to a minimum of 100 temperature cycles. One temperature cycle shall consist of the following sequence: The temperature shall be stabilized at -65 °F and maintained for 55 minutes. The temperature shall then be raised to 350 °F in 5 minutes and maintained for 55 minutes and then lowered to -65 °F in 5 minutes. One cycle shall have a 2-hour duration.

4.5.14 Minimum bend/flex. Six DCAs shall be wrapped in a 1-inch-diameter helix along the centerline for four complete revolutions and shall remain in that configuration for 2 hours. At the end of this period, the assemblies shall be test fired in accordance with 4.5.18.

4.5.15 Flexure (type II only). Type II samples, in accordance with table II, shall be subjected to 3,000 cycles at a maximum rate of 6 cycles per minute. One cycle shall consist of moving the canopy from the closed-locked position to the extreme open position and back to the closed and locked position. After cycling, the lines shall be X-rayed in accordance with 4.5.5.1.

4.5.16 Salt fog. The salt fog test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM B117 except that sea water per ASTM D1141 shall be used in place of a 5 percent salt solution. The control of pH and salt impurity requirements per ASTM B117 shall not apply. Test duration shall be 168 hours. The DCAs shall be rinsed with tap water without disassembly. At the completion of this test, the assemblies shall be visually inspected in accordance with 4.5.4 and 4.5.6, then test fired in accordance with 4.5.18.

4.5.17 Solvent resistance. Six DCAs shall be subjected to repeated exposure to general purpose cleaner (A-A-59281, type I) in accordance with table V (see 3.6.9). Each exposure requires the line to be fully submerged in the cleaner for 10 seconds minimum, then allowed to air dry completely. At the completion of this test, the assemblies shall be visually inspected in accordance with 4.5.4 and 4.5.6, then test fired in accordance with 4.5.18.

TABLE V. Exposures for each line number.

DCA line number	Number of exposures
1	35
2	40
3	45
4	50
5	60
6	70

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4.5.18 Ballistic testing. In accordance with table I and III, the DCAs shall be grouped into two equal sections with one group conditioned at -65±5 °F and the other group conditioned at 200±5 °F for 4 hours minimum to 24 hours maximum. The DCAs shall then be functionally tested within 5 minutes after removal from the conditioning chamber using a number 8 blasting cap on the test tip. DCAs shall be fired through a sensitivity connector (Drawing 841AS801) into a sensitivity fixture from a tee (Drawing 841AS802) that is fired from one of two Shielded Mild Detonating Cord (SMDC) test tips. Each DCA shall have a 1-inch diameter loop in the assembly when tested. The output end should be placed on a 6061-T6 aluminum dent block (Drawing 841AS803) secured in a dent block holder (Drawing 841AS804). The DCA shall meet the requirements of 3.7. Failure of any DCA to meet the requirements of 3.7 shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented.

4.5.18.1 Retest. There shall be no retests except as defined in 4.5.18.2.

4.5.18.2 Test failure. If a test failure is attributable to an assignable cause, excluding the DCAs, the original test results shall be discarded and that portion of the test reconducted using a retain sample from the lot.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Generally, both type I and type II DCAs are intended as a rapid energy source to provide an explosive release signal in aircraft emergency systems. Specifically, type II (see 1.2.1.a) lines are used in areas requiring more flexure during their life cycle than type I (see 1.2.1.b) lines. Type II lines have a protective coating to prevent damage and are required to pass additional cycling tests. These items were specifically designed for use in military aircraft, and thus have no commercial application.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type of DCA required (see 1.2).
c. When first article inspection is required (see 3.1 and 4.2).
d. Materials required as established by the technical service release (see 3.3).
e. First article sample size, if other than as specified (see 4.2).
f. Production lot size and test activity (see 4.3).
g. Ballistic sample size, if other than as specified (see 4.4.2).
h. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).
i. Applicable safety precaution requirements (see 6.5).

6.3 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the items should be a first article sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results, and disposition of the first article lot. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such previous production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.4 Definitions.

6.4.1 DCA. The explosive transmission mechanism used to provide a transfer path of explosive stimulus from one pyrotechnic device to another.

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6.5 Safety precautions. When specified (see 6.2), the safety precaution requirements of the "DoD Contractors' Safety Manual for Ammunition and Explosives," DoD Manual 4145.26, are applicable. NOTE: When this specification is used as a part of the description of work to be accomplished by a Government activity, the safety precaution requirements of "Ammunition and Explosives," OP 5, are applicable.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Aluminum
HNS
Lead azide
Shielded mild detonating cord (SMDC)

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Preparing activity:
Navy – OS
(Project 1377-2024-008)

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